

Financial Aid Satisfactory Academic Progress Policy (SAP) – Life and Career Studies program

Federal regulations require financial aid recipients to maintain “satisfactory academic progress (SAP)” towards the program’s recognized certificates and completion requirements. Satisfactory academic progress applies to all undergraduate students who receive any type of financial assistance administered by the university and will be reviewed after every payment period (summer/fall/spring). **A student must be eligible by this policy whether or not a recipient of aid during the evaluated period of attendance.**

This policy is modeled after the university’s standard satisfactory academic progress policy, which includes both qualitative and quantitative standards. These standards are defined below. All periods of a student’s enrollment, whether or not the student received aid, are included.

Qualitative and Quantitative Standards

Students in the Life and Career Studies program typically enroll in 6-9 credits listed in the regular course catalogue per term composed of academics and co-operative/employment education coursework. Additional instruction addresses the development of independent and community living skills. The combination of coursework from the course catalogue and independent and living skills instruction comprises the student’s fulltime load. Satisfactory academic progress is determined by applying the qualitative and quantitative standards to these dimensions.

Qualitative Measure. The qualitative measure is based on the percentage of academic audited coursework and semester independent and community living assessments for which the student receives a holistic rating of “Met Expectations” or higher on a five-point goal attainment scale. A sample template for a five-point goal attainment scale is presented below; goals and level descriptors are customized based the student’s person-centered plan, course/instructional expectations, and/or student learning needs:

Goal	Level 1: Significantly Below Expectations	Level 2: Below Expectations	Level 3: Met Expectations	Level 4: Exceeded Expectations	Level 5: Significantly Exceeded Expectations
Goal #1 E.g., Attendance, Participation, Work Completion, Assignment Quality, Personal Care, Decision- Making, Teamwork, etc.	Student rarely or never demonstrates targeted goal at an acceptable level of performance.	Student’s level of performance of targeted goal is inconsistent and/or unpredictable.	Student demonstrates targeted goal consistently at an acceptable level of performance.	Student demonstrates the targeted goal with a high level of consistency at a level of performance that frequently exceeds expectations.	Student demonstrates the targeted goal nearly all of the time at a level of performance that exceeds or significantly exceeds expectations.
Goal #2					
Goal #3					
Holistic Rating					

Students must complete 67% of the combination of university catalog semester hours and instruction in independent and community living attempted each semester and cumulatively with a holistic rating of met expectations or higher.

Quantitative Measure. The quantitative measure is based on the length of time needed for completion of the program. A student must complete the program within 150% of the time frame established.

2. Review Process: Student records will be reviewed each term.

3. Financial Aid Warning: When a student does not complete 67% of academic coursework and instruction in independent and community living in a semester or cumulatively, a Financial Aid Warning is imposed. Aid will continue during the term in which the student is on Financial Aid Warning.

4. Financial Aid Suspension: The student's financial aid will be terminated for all future semesters until he/she can return his/her academic record to good standing for Satisfactory Academic Progress, if one or more of the following occur:

- The student does not meet the criteria of Satisfactory Academic Progress while on Financial Aid Warning.
- The student has a conditional acceptance to the program and does not meet the criteria for Satisfactory Academic Progress.
- The student does not at least meet expectation in any academic course nor in independent living and community living in a single term.
- The student fails to meet the conditions for Financial Aid Probation.

5. Appeal Process. There is an appeal process for students who have their aid terminated.

- The form and instruction are included with the communication to the student at the time of termination. Circumstances may warrant an appeal including, but are not limited to, the following examples: Medical reasons, fulltime employment, or being out of school for a long period of time. Documentation should be provided to support circumstances. Examples of documentation are: medical documents, copy of death certificates or obituary, letters from third parties (therapist, doctor, supervisor at work, etc.)
- The time allowed for completing the appeal will be noted in the communication to the student. It is typically within two weeks of the end of the term that the action occurred and/or within the first week of classes.
- The appeal committee consists of various members from the Financial Aid and Educational Funding Office, faculty, and program coordinator. The Financial Aid and Educational Funding Office will notify the student of the decision with two weeks of receiving the appeal.

Financial Aid Probation: When an appeal is granted a student is placed on Financial Aid Probation. Probation is allowed for one term and the student must return to good standing for Satisfactory Academic Progress, unless the student has an approved academic plan in place which includes conditions of the probation and notes when the student will return to good standing for Satisfactory Academic Progress.

Treatment of courses:

- Withdrawals: Counted as attempted credits.
- Incompletes: Counted as attempted credits, not count as earned credits. Once an incomplete grade for academic coursework or independent and community living instruction is resolved, the student can contact the Financial Aid and Educational Finding Office to have measures of Satisfactory Academic Progress recalculated. This responsibility relies on the student.
- Repeat courses: Academic courses repeated will show as credits attempted and credits earned. The highest grade will be considered in calculations of Satisfactory Academic Progress.
- Audited courses: Audited courses will be graded AU (Successful Audit), UAU (Unsuccessful Audit), based on the goal attainment scale, or WAU (Withdrawal Audit)
- Transfer credit: Counted as attempted credits and earned credits.
- Grade Change: It is the students' responsibility to notify the Financial Aid and Educational Funding Office of a grade change and to reevaluate the student's record for SAP.